

Neil Chavez

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SUMMARY

Staff IT Engineer with 9+ years of experience across identity, automation, and cloud infrastructure, built entirely through hands-on work across dozens of environments. MSP background means deep exposure to complexity, variety, and operational pressure that most internal engineers never encounter.

Currently serving as Director of IT Engineering & Automation at Diligex, owning technical architecture, identity systems, security, and automation strategy.

Focused on environments that treat IT as an engineering discipline, not just a help desk. Where identity is managed centrally, infrastructure is managed as code, and automation does the work we shouldn't need to do manually.

EXPERIENCE

Diligex

Jul 2026 – Present | Remote

Director of IT Engineering & Automation

- Transitioned from Director of Projects & Implementation into a newly defined technical leadership seat, shifting focus to architecture, security, and automation.
- Serve as the acting Chief Security Officer for Diligex, owning security strategy, posture, and governance, including both written policies and hands-on implementation of security controls and tooling.
- Responsible for driving automation across Diligex's internal and client-facing operations, eliminating manual processes and building systems that scale without adding headcount.
- Moved Diligex's internal infrastructure to code-managed systems using Terraform, bringing Entra ID configuration, Conditional Access policies, and M365 security baselines under version control with a GitHub Actions CI/CD pipeline.
- Serve as the technical architecture authority for client projects, making design decisions and providing guidance on complex engagements before and during execution.
- Mentor the Senior Systems Engineer, serving as the staff-level escalation point for complex technical issues, and remain available as a high-level final escalation resource for critical 24x7 incidents.

Jan 2026 – Jun 2026 | Remote

Director, Projects & Implementation

- Promoted into a Director-level role while serving as the sole hands-on technical executor across all client engagements, owning architecture, implementation, and delivery end to end without a dedicated engineering team.
- Owned the Projects and Implementation Department end to end as project manager, lead technical architect, and sole project engineer, tracking KPIs including Project CSAT and budget hour performance, consistently maintaining green scores across both metrics.
- Led a large-scale, multi-phase infrastructure modernization for a multi-site energy sector client spanning 14 locations, encompassing an HQ office move, on-premises file server migration to Azure Files, hub-and-spoke network redesign to independent branch networks with IPSEC tunnel connectivity to Azure, AD to Entra ID migration, Intune rollout, full security stack deployment (AutoElevate, Huntress ITDR, Defender for M365), and integration of an acquired competitor including M365 tenant migration.
- Served as the sole security engineer for Diligex, conducting NIST-based Security Risk Assessments and formally authoring Diligex's internal Incident Response Plan, establishing the company's security governance foundation.
- Participated as a core member of the Diligex leadership team, contributing to strategic decisions including service line development, pricing, hiring, client profitability, and EBITDA discussions.
- Contributed to Diligex's EOS operating system rollout as one of three principals, designing the org chart, defining 1/3/10 year goals, and establishing the L10 meeting cadence from the ground up.

Oct 2022 – Dec 2025 | Remote

Senior Systems Engineer

- Architected and deployed Microsoft 365 and Google Workspace tenant environments, including tenant-to-tenant migrations, Exchange to M365 migrations, and full AD to Azure AD transitions.
- Owned Conditional Access policy design across client environments, MFA enforcement, geo-blocking, and enterprise app SSO integrations via Entra ID.
- Administered Okta in a production client environment, configured SSO integrations, designed access and session policies for segmented user tiers, and built Okta Workflows automation for user lifecycle events including Slack-based onboarding notifications.
- Served as the sole security engineer at Diligex, conducting NIST-based Security Risk Assessments and producing scored evaluations and phased remediation plans across DLP, ITDR, PAM, and SaaS backup.
- Acted as the client-facing technical lead on calls with CIOs, CTOs, and IT Directors across multiple clients, serving as the senior technical authority and primary L3 escalation point.
- Administered MDM platforms including Intune for Windows and Addigy for macOS across the client portfolio, handling enrollment, compliance policies, and endpoint security enforcement at scale.

- Progressively took on project leadership responsibilities as technical lead and primary architect on client projects, forming the foundation for a promotion into a Director-level role.

Nov 2020 – Oct 2022 | Hybrid – New York, NY

IT Systems Engineer

- Supported and administered Microsoft 365 and Google Workspace environments including identity systems, device management, and end-user infrastructure across diverse client organizations.
- Took on increasing MDM ownership including Intune and early Addigy exposure, and led migrations including Exchange to Exchange Online, file server migrations, and tenant-to-tenant migrations.
- Maintained on-call rotation throughout this role and stepped into L3 escalations, advanced identity and endpoint work, and project ownership ahead of a formal promotion to Senior Systems Engineer.

Nov 2019 – Nov 2020 | Onsite – New York, NY

IT Technician

- Delivered hands-on technical support as the primary NYC-area field technician, serving as the dedicated on-site IT resource for a key client with twice-weekly visits, and owned employee onboarding and offboarding end to end.
- Joined the on-call rotation within two months and began handling Level 2 tickets within five months, progressing to a formal Level 2 promotion within one year.

Dynamic Business Systems

Oct 2018 – Nov 2019 | Onsite – New York, NY

IT Support Specialist

- Provided helpdesk support across Windows and macOS enterprise environments, building foundational skills in troubleshooting, user administration, and system configuration that formed the starting point of an IT engineering career.

SKILLS

Identity & Access Entra ID, Okta, Okta Workflows, Conditional Access, PIM, SSO, SAML, OIDC/OAuth, SCIM, RBAC, MFA, BYOD & app protection policies

Cloud Platforms Microsoft 365, Azure (VNETs, VMs, Storage, Private DNS, Azure Files), Google Workspace

Device & Endpoint Intune, Addigy (certified), Autopilot, Zero Touch Provisioning, MDM, macOS & Windows fleet management

Security NIST Risk Assessments, Incident Response, Zero Trust, DLP (Microsoft Purview), ITDR, PAM, Microsoft Defender for M365, Huntress, AutoElevate, DNSFilter, Microsoft GSA, Mimecast, Ironscales, MailRoute

Automation & IaC PowerShell, Bash, TypeScript, Node.js, Rewst, Jinja, Terraform, HCP Terraform, GitHub Actions, Git/GitHub, GitOps, CI/CD pipelines, Railway

Infrastructure Systems architecture, Azure infrastructure, hybrid cloud environments, on-premises to cloud migrations, network architecture and design, IPSEC/VPN, disaster recovery, environment standardization

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft 365 Endpoint Administrator (2020) | Cisco Meraki CMNA (2021) | Addigy ACE (2024)

PORTFOLIO

Full portfolio at neilchvz.github.io/infrastructure-portfolio

Diligex — Internal Projects

ISP Outage Monitoring & Ticket Automation | *Rewst · UptimeRobot · ConnectWise Manage*

Fully automated ISP outage ticket lifecycle built in Rewst. Polls UptimeRobot monitor status every minute via API, identifies the correct client and board in ConnectWise, opens a ticket on outage detection, and closes it with a resolution note when connectivity restores. Replaced two previous failed approaches. A Level 2 technician can now add a new monitor in UptimeRobot and the automation handles everything from the next run forward with no workflow changes required.

FileVault Compliance Automation | *Addigy · macOS Security & MDM*

Two continuous Addigy Flex Policies that detect and remediate FileVault compliance gaps across all managed macOS fleets. Policy 1 deploys Escrow Buddy to silently rotate and escrow missing recovery keys. Policy 2 enables FileVault via deferred MDM enrollment for non-compliant devices. Both run continuously with no scheduled audits and no technician involvement required.

Personal Projects

Caira HQ Identity Platform | *Okta · Google Workspace · Terraform · GitHub Actions · Okta Workflows · TypeScript*

Production identity platform on cairahq.com: Okta federated to Google Workspace via SAML 2.0, SCIM provisioning, NIST 800-63B aligned policies, and infrastructure managed as code via Terraform with a full GitHub Actions CI/CD pipeline and HCP Terraform remote state. Event-driven lifecycle automation via Okta Workflows. TypeScript onboarding service hosted on Railway that automates PR creation for user provisioning via the GitHub API.